FIGHTERBASE

DASH-style

Diet guide

Heart-healthy: veg, fruit, low-fat dairy, less salt.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap DASH-style**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is DASH-style?

Short for Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension. Designed to support healthy blood pressure, with plenty of fruit, veg, whole grains and low-fat dairy, and less salt.

Where it comes from

DASH stands for Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension. It was developed from US research funded by the National Institutes of Health in the 1990s to lower blood pressure.

The main ideas

1. Lots of vegetables, fruit and wholegrains.
2. Low-fat dairy, fish, poultry, beans, nuts.
3. Less red meat, sweets and sugary drinks.
4. Less salt. A standard goal in the research was up to a teaspoon (about 2,300 mg sodium) a day, with a lower level tested in some trials.
5. Fewer foods high in saturated fat.

Who it suits

- People who have been advised to lower blood pressure
- People wanting a heart-friendly pattern
- Anyone with a family history of high blood pressure

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
>
> - You already take blood pressure medicine (talk to your doctor before changing your diet or salt)
> - You have kidney disease (potassium and fluid advice may differ)
> - You sweat heavily and are advised to add salt around training. Ask a dietitian

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Wholegrains, fruit and potatoes (with skin) give carbs.
- Low-fat dairy, fish, chicken and beans give protein.
- Heavy sweaters in camp may need more sodium than the standard advice. Get personal advice rather than guessing.
- Fruit and a handful of unsalted nuts is an easy snack.

> Plenty of carbs from whole grains and fruit. Watch salt in sports drinks if you're reducing it, but don't cut fluids.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Potassium
helps balance sodium
Where: bananas, potatoes, beans, spinach, yoghurt

Calcium and magnesium
part of the DASH pattern
Where: low-fat dairy, nuts, leafy greens, wholegrains

Protein
keep it up when cutting meat
Where: fish, poultry, beans, low-fat dairy

Sodium
this is the one to limit
Where: bread, sauces, processed meat, ready meals, soup

Common mistakes

- Cutting salt at the table but not noticing processed foods
- Replacing salt with a high-potassium salt substitute without medical advice
- Low-fat products with extra sugar
- Not reading labels

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Salt per 100 g: more than 1.5 g is high, 0.3 g or less is low (UK)
- Sodium x 2.5 = salt
- Stock cubes, soy sauce, cured meats, cheese and bread are common high-salt foods

Eating out

- Ask for sauces and dressings on the side.
- Choose grilled, steamed or baked over fried or pickled.
- Skip extra salt and salty sides like olives and cured meats.
- Ask for no added salt where possible.

Easy swaps

Table salt	→	Herbs, lemon, garlic, pepper and spices
Salted nuts	→	Unsalted nuts
Ready-made sauces	→	Home-made tomato sauce
Bacon	→	Fresh chicken or eggs

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Porridge with banana and skimmed milk	Chicken and salad wholemeal sandwich	Baked salmon, potatoes, broccoli
Tue	Low-fat yoghurt, berries, oats	Lentil soup (low salt)	Chicken stir-fry with brown rice
Wed	Wholegrain cereal, milk, fruit	Tuna and bean salad	Turkey chilli with rice
Thu	Eggs on wholemeal toast, tomatoes	Jacket potato with beans	Cod, new potatoes, green beans
Fri	Fruit smoothie with oats	Chickpea salad wrap	Lean beef and vegetable stew
Sat	Porridge with nuts	Vegetable and bean soup	Chicken, sweet potato, greens
Sun	Omelette with vegetables	Leftovers bowl	Roast chicken, potatoes, veg

Snacks

Fruit · Unsalted nuts · Low-fat yoghurt · Carrot sticks · Wholegrain crackers (low salt)

Shopping list

Fresh and frozen vegetables and fruit · Wholemeal bread, oats, brown rice, potatoes · Skinless poultry, fish, eggs · Beans and lentils (no added salt) · Low-fat milk and yoghurt · Unsalted nuts, herbs and spices

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

Does DASH work quickly?

In the original trials blood pressure fell within a couple of weeks. Results vary, so keep any medical monitoring going.

Is it OK for athletes?

Yes, but heavy sweaters may need extra sodium around hard sessions. A sports dietitian can set that for you.

Further reading

British Heart Foundation; Blood Pressure UK; NHS salt guidance; US NHLBI DASH materials.



For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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